

LISACAIRNSGROUPEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're here in Brisbane at the magnificent Arrival Australia, the travel industry show and I've run into Lisa Chambers from the Cairns Adventure Group. Lisa, welcome to the program. Thanks very much.

And Lisa, tell us about, first of all, your impressions of the Arrival conference here in Brisbane. What do you think? Yeah, it's definitely been very inspiring for certain and a lot of talk about AI as it's a big topic right now. Today is day two and we're hearing a bit more about the other side of travel, not just AI, which is great.

I'm learning a lot. And you're one of the keynote speakers here, I hear, yesterday. Yesterday, I don't know.

Yeah, I joined a panel about AI, actually, funnily enough. I'm not going to lie, I did feel a little bit imposter syndrome in the sense that we do use AI in our business, but I don't think, I think we can be doing more. But nonetheless, it was more to give some insights from a small to medium business what we're doing.

And how do you use AI in your business? Look, in all fairness, it's mainly automation at this stage, but we are looking to introduce it to be part of our customer service. And yeah, we're looking for other areas of where AI is going to help with efficiencies. Now, Cairns Adventure Group, you're in such a beautiful part of the world.

And I've been there myself. Cairns is a fantastic part of Queensland. Tell us about Cairns Adventure Group and what you do.

So Cairns Adventure Group, we have lots of different activities. So it's adventures for everyone. And it genuinely is.

We take people up into the rainforest or up into the tablelands to check out all the beautiful, magnificent waterfalls. We also take people whitewater rafting. So we've got the Tully rafting, which is Australia's number one river to raft.

We also have the barren rafting for those that aren't quite so thrill-seeking. And then for the little ones and the multi-generational families, we've got the rainforest river tubing. So that's great.

We also offer jet boating, river cruises, and boat hire. And I know that Cairns is such a big destination for all the backpackers. They travel from, you know, the Gold Coast up to Cairns and stop on the way.

And you're one of their end points before they hit the Daintree, right? That's correct. Yes. And we do take them up to the Daintree on day trips and overnight trips as well.

But yes, a lot of backpackers, but we've definitely seen that market change. I don't really refer to them as backpackers anymore, more adventure travellers, because they've gone to the days when they're just 18 and they're over for the first time for a year. They might be 35 and heading out this way.

So yeah, looking for that kind of more immersive experience. And for those internationally listening to the program, there's programs in Australia where people can actually come and work here for up to a year. And a lot of towns like Cairns rely on those people too.

Yeah, absolutely. Really big for hospitality and our tourism businesses as well. Obviously they come through and they come and work in the busier periods when we need them.

And then they go off and travel in the less busier periods, which is great. We love And what are some of your standout experiences that you'd recommend for people coming to Cairns via Cairns Adventure Group? As in my personal experience? Yeah, your personal ones. Yeah.

Oh God, there's so much to do. And I mean, you've got to go to the Great Barrier Reef, obviously. Personally, my favourite is Reef Magic.

And then you have to go up into the rainforest. So we'll take you up there, but you can also do Skyrail. That's pretty epic.

And then there's Rainforest Station, the Wildlife Park. So yeah, there's lots to do. You need to have like two weeks in Cairns alone.

And speaking of the reef, I mean, I've been out there myself on the Reef Explorer boat and you don't have to be a diver. You can go, you can actually do assisted dives and you can, and just snorkelling out there is magnificent. Snorkelling is magnificent.

I don't think you need to dive. In fact, sometimes being above that reef and just, just slightly above the reef, you can see a lot more. There's, you know, when you're diving, there is still lots to see, but the fish life is all on top of the reef anyway.

So yeah, snorkelling's great. Yeah. And there's been talk about bleaching of the reef and things like that, but that's really only a tiny, tiny part of the reef, isn't it? It's pretty much untouched and a lot of stories of flying around overseas that the reef is in a bad way, but that's not really the case, right? No, with our Great Barrier Reef, our tourists actually help us keep that reef nice and healthy.

By going out and visiting the reef, you actually support the operators that look after it and do all the restoration and the regrowth of the reef. So yeah, tourism actually does a great thing for our reef. So definitely come and see it.

We're speaking to Lisa Chambers from Cairns Adventure Group. How can people find out more

about you and Cairns Adventure Group online? Well, you can find us on all our social platforms. You can also find us on our website, cairnsadventuregroup.com.au. So yeah, we're everywhere.

You'll find us if you look for us. Great. Looking forward to seeing you in Cairns.

Thanks, Lisa. Thank you. Cheers, Geoff.

Thanks.